ADDIS ABABA UNIVERSITY

A COMPREHENSIVE BIOGRAPHY

Prepared For: Research and Documentation Purpose

Date: March 2026

TABLE OF CONTENTS

INTRODUCTION AND OVERVIEW 3

HISTORY AND FOUNDING 4

MISSION, VISION, AND CORE VALUES 6

FACULTIES AND DEPARTMENTS 7

ACADEMIC PROGRAMS AND RESEARCH INITIATIVES 9

STUDENT LIFE AND CAMPUS FACILITIES 11

LIBRARY AND RESEARCH RESOURCES 13

ACHIEVEMENTS AND RECOGNITIONS 15

PARTNERSHIPS AND COLLABORATIONS 17

CONTACT INFORMATION 19

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION AND OVERVIEW

1.1 University at a Glance

Attribute	Details
Full Name	Addis Ababa University (AAU)
Established	1950
Founder	His Imperial Majesty Emperor Haile Selassie I
Type	Public Research University
Location	Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
Campuses	14 (Main Campus: Sidist Kilo)
Students	Approximately 50,000 (graduate and undergraduate)
Academic Staff	Over 2,500
Administrative Staff	Approximately 3,500
Language of Instruction	English and Amharic
Accreditation	Ministry of Education, Ethiopia
Motto	"Seek Wisdom, Elevate Your Intellect and Character"
Colors	Blue and White
Website	www.aau.edu.et

1.2 Overview

Addis Ababa University (AAU) is the oldest and largest higher education institution in Ethiopia. Located in the nation's capital, Addis Ababa, the university serves as the country's premier center for higher learning, research, and community engagement. As

Ethiopia's flagship university, AAU has played a pivotal role in shaping the nation's intellectual landscape, producing generations of leaders, scholars, and professionals who have contributed significantly to the country's development and beyond.

The university operates through a multi-campus system spread across Addis Ababa, with the main administrative and historical campus located at Sidist Kilo (6 Kilo). Other major campuses include the Arat Kilo Campus (College of Natural Sciences), the Amist Kilo Campus (College of Social Sciences), and specialized campuses for health sciences, veterinary medicine, and technology.

AAU offers a comprehensive range of academic programs spanning undergraduate, graduate, and doctoral levels across various disciplines. The institution has established itself as a research-intensive university, hosting numerous research institutes and centers that address critical national and regional challenges in areas such as Ethiopian studies, development studies, public health, biotechnology, and climate change.

SECTION 2: HISTORY AND FOUNDING

2.1 The Founding Era (1950-1960)

Addis Ababa University traces its origins to 1950 with the establishment of the University College of Addis Ababa (UCAA). His Imperial Majesty Emperor Haile Selassie I, recognizing the crucial need for higher education in Ethiopia's modernization efforts, founded the institution with initial support from Canadian Jesuit educators.

Timeline of Founding:

Year	Milestone
1950	University College of Addis Ababa established at Sidist Kilo campus
1950-1952	Initial collaboration with McGill University, Montreal, Canada
1952	First buildings constructed at the main campus

1954	First graduating class of 12 students completed their degrees
1955	Affiliation with London University for external degree programs

The original University College consisted of four faculties:

- Faculty of Arts
- Faculty of Science
- Faculty of Education
- Faculty of Theology (Holy Trinity College)

2.2 Expansion and Transformation (1961-1974)

A pivotal moment in the university's history occurred in 1961 when Emperor Haile Selassie issued a charter establishing Haile Selassie I University, consolidating several existing institutions of higher education in Addis Ababa:

Institutions Merged in 1961:

- University College of Addis Ababa (Sidist Kilo)
- College of Engineering (Amist Kilo)
- Ethio-Swedish Institute of Building Technology
- Imperial Ethiopian College of Agriculture and Mechanical Arts (later moved to Alemaya)
- Public Health College (Gondar)
- College of Business Administration
- Holy Trinity Theological College
- School of Social Work

2.3 Post-Revolution Era (1974-1991)

Following the Ethiopian Revolution in 1974, the university was renamed Addis Ababa University, reflecting the broader political changes in the country. This period witnessed:

- Increased government control over academic affairs
- Expansion of programs aligned with socialist development policies
- Establishment of research institutes focused on Ethiopian studies
- Growth in student enrollment despite political challenges

2.4 Modern Era (1991-Present)

Since the 1990s, AAU has undergone significant transformation:

Major Developments:

Period	Key Developments
1993-2000	Introduction of graduate programs expansion; decentralization reforms
2000-2010	Massive enrollment growth; establishment of new campuses; research capacity building
2010-2020	Strategic focus on becoming a research university; international partnerships expansion
2020-Present	Digital transformation initiatives; curriculum modernization; global ranking improvements

2.5 Founding Visionaries

Key Figures in AAU's Establishment:

Name	Role	Contribution
Emperor Haile Selassie I	Founder and Patron	Established and personally supported the university

Dr. Lucien Matte, SJ	First President	Canadian Jesuit who led initial development (1950-1954)
Dr. Harold S. Walmsley	Second President	Continued institutional development (1954-1960)
Dr. Tesfai Tasew	First Ethiopian President	Led transition to Haile Selassie I University
Dr. Aklog Birara	Early Academic Leader	Developed arts and humanities programs

SECTION 3: MISSION, VISION, AND CORE VALUES

3.1 Vision Statement

"To be a pre-eminent African university, renowned for its excellence in teaching, learning, research, and community engagement, contributing to the sustainable development of Ethiopia and the world."

3.2 Mission Statement

Addis Ababa University is committed to:

- **Producing Competent Graduates:** Provide high-quality education that develops skilled, ethical, and innovative professionals capable of addressing national and global challenges.
- **Advancing Knowledge Through Research:** Conduct cutting-edge research that contributes to scientific discovery, technological innovation, and evidence-based policy development.
- **Community Engagement:** Extend knowledge and expertise to serve the needs of local, national, and international communities.

- **Preserving Cultural Heritage:** Document, preserve, and promote Ethiopia's rich cultural and historical heritage through specialized institutes and programs.
- **Fostering International Cooperation:** Build strategic partnerships with leading universities and research institutions worldwide to enhance academic excellence and global understanding.

3.3 Core Values

Value	Description
Excellence	Commitment to the highest standards in teaching, research, and service
Academic Freedom	Protection of intellectual inquiry, expression, and scholarly pursuit
Integrity	Adherence to ethical principles in all academic and administrative activities
Diversity and Inclusion	Respect for diverse perspectives, cultures, and backgrounds
Innovation	Encouragement of creative thinking and novel approaches to challenges
Social Responsibility	Dedication to addressing societal needs and promoting sustainable development
Collaboration	Fostering partnerships within and beyond the academic community
Cultural Preservation	Commitment to protecting and promoting Ethiopia's heritage

3.4 Strategic Objectives (2021-2025)

Strategic Pillars:

Academic Excellence and Relevance

- Curriculum modernization aligned with national development priorities
- Enhanced student-centered learning environments
- Strengthened graduate programs and PhD training

Research and Innovation

- Increased research output and publications in high-impact journals
- Commercialization of research findings
- Establishment of centers of excellence in priority areas

Institutional Transformation

- Digital transformation of administrative and academic processes
- Improved governance and management systems
- Sustainable resource mobilization

Internationalization

- Expanded international partnerships and networks
- Increased foreign student enrollment
- Enhanced global visibility and recognition

Community Engagement

- Strengthened technology transfer and extension services
- Public policy advisory services
- Cultural preservation and promotion

SECTION 4: FACULTIES AND DEPARTMENTS

4.1 Academic Structure Overview

Addis Ababa University operates through a collegiate system comprising 10 colleges, 7 institutes, and several specialized schools and departments spread across its 14 campuses.

4.2 Colleges and Their Departments

College	Established	Key Departments/Schools	Campus
College of Natural and Computational Sciences	1950 (as Faculty of Science)	Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Mathematics, Statistics, Computer Science, Biotechnology, Environmental Science	Arat Kilo
College of Social Sciences	1950	Sociology, Psychology, Geography, History, Philosophy, Political Science, Anthropology	Amist Kilo
College of Humanities, Language Studies, Journalism and Communication	1950	Ethiopian Languages, Foreign Languages, Linguistics, Journalism, Communication, Literature	Sidist Kilo
College of Business and Economics	1956	Accounting, Finance, Management, Marketing, Economics, Public Administration	Sidist Kilo
College of Law and Governance Studies	1963	Law, Governance Studies, Human Rights	Sidist Kilo

College of Education and Behavioral Studies	1961	Educational Planning, Psychology, Special Needs Education, Curriculum Studies	Sidist Kilo
College of Health Sciences	2005 (reorganized)	Medicine, Nursing, Pharmacy, Public Health, Medical Laboratory Sciences, Psychiatry	Tikur Anbessa
College of Veterinary Medicine and Agriculture	1963	Veterinary Medicine, Animal Science, Veterinary Public Health	Bishoftu
College of Development Studies	1995	Development Economics, Environment and Development, Gender Studies	Sidist Kilo
College of Performing and Visual Arts	1978 (as Yared School of Music)	Music, Theater Arts, Fine Arts, Design	Sidist Kilo

4.3 Institutes and Centers

Institute	Focus Area	Established
Institute of Ethiopian Studies	Ethiopian history, culture, languages, and heritage preservation	1963
Institute of Educational Research	Educational policy, curriculum development, and teacher education	1969
Institute of Development and Policy Research	Policy analysis, development research, and advisory services	2010
Institute of Biotechnology	Molecular biology, genetic engineering, bioinformatics	2004
Institute of Geophysics, Space Science and Astronomy	Seismology, space science, astronomical research	2015
Institute of Water and Environment	Water resources, climate change, environmental management	2016

Ethiopian Institute of Architecture, Building Construction and City Development (EiABC)	Architecture, urban planning, construction technology	1954 (reorganized 2010)

4.4 Specialized Schools

- School of Pharmacy
- School of Public Health
- School of Allied Health Sciences
- School of Information Science
- School of Commerce
- School of Social Work
- Yared School of Music
- School of Journalism and Communication

4.5 Research Centers

Center	Research Focus
African Population and Health Research Center	Demographic and health research
Center for African Studies	Pan-African research and scholarship
Center for Environmental Science	Climate change, biodiversity, pollution
Center for Food Security Studies	Food systems, nutrition, agricultural policy
Center for Gender Studies	Gender equality, women's empowerment
Center for Human Rights	Human rights research and advocacy
Center for Materials Science	Advanced materials research
Center for Molecular Biosciences	Genomics, proteomics, drug discovery

SECTION 5: ACADEMIC PROGRAMS AND RESEARCH INITIATIVES

5.1 Academic Programs Overview

Addis Ababa University offers a comprehensive range of academic programs at undergraduate, graduate, and doctoral levels, serving approximately 50,000 students annually.

Program Distribution:

Level	Number of Programs	Approximate Enrollment
Undergraduate	120+	35,000
Master's	250+	12,000
PhD	80+	3,000
Certificate/Diploma	30+	1,500

5.2 Undergraduate Programs

5.2.1 Admission Requirements

- Ethiopian University Entrance Examination Certificate
- Minimum grade requirements vary by program
- Placement through Ministry of Education centralized system

5.2.2 Program Structure

- Duration: 3-5 years depending on program
- Credit-based system (ECTS compatible)
- Includes general education, core courses, and electives
- Final year research project or thesis

5.2.3 Sample Undergraduate Programs

College	Sample Programs
Natural Sciences	B.Sc. in Physics, Chemistry, Biology, Mathematics, Computer Science
Social Sciences	B.A. in Sociology, Psychology, Geography, History
Humanities	B.A. in Ethiopian Languages, English Literature, Linguistics
Business	B.A. in Accounting, Management, Economics
Health Sciences	Doctor of Medicine (MD), B.Pharm, B.Sc. Nursing
Law	LL.B (Bachelor of Laws)
Engineering	B.Sc. in Civil, Electrical, Mechanical, Chemical Engineering (EiABC)

5.3 Graduate Programs

5.3.1 Master's Programs

Addis Ababa University is Ethiopia's leading institution for graduate education, offering over 250 master's programs.

Admission Requirements:

- Bachelor's degree in relevant field
- Minimum GPA requirement (typically 2.50 or higher)
- Entrance examination or interview

- Two academic references

Program Types:

- Coursework-based master's (30-36 credit hours)
- Thesis-based master's (with research component)
- Professional master's (MBA, MPA, etc.)

5.3.2 PhD Programs

AAU produces the majority of Ethiopia's PhD graduates, with programs designed to develop independent researchers and scholars.

Admission Requirements:

- Master's degree in relevant field
- Research proposal
- Entrance examination
- Interview with potential supervisor

PhD Program Structure:

- Coursework component (typically 1 year)
- Comprehensive examination
- Original research dissertation
- Defense and publication requirements

5.4 Flagship Research Initiatives

5.4.1 Priority Research Areas

Priority Area	Key Research Themes	Partner Institutions
Health and Biomedicine	Infectious diseases, maternal health, non-communicable diseases, traditional medicine	WHO, CDC, NIH, Karolinska Institutet

Agriculture and Food Security	Crop improvement, livestock health, climate-resilient agriculture	CGIAR, FAO, Wageningen University
Water and Environment	Water resource management, climate change adaptation, biodiversity conservation	UNESCO, IUCN, Stockholm University
Renewable Energy	Solar, wind, geothermal, energy policy	UNDP, GIZ, KTH Royal Institute
Social Transformation	Governance, migration, urbanization, gender equality	IDRC, CODESRIA, University of Oxford
Heritage Studies	Cultural preservation, museum studies, manuscript digitization	British Library, UNESCO

5.4.2 Major Research Centers and Projects

The Ethiopian Academy of Sciences

- Established in 2010
- Promotes scientific excellence and evidence-based policy
- Publishes the Ethiopian Journal of Sciences

The Armauer Hansen Research Institute (AHRI)

- Collaborative research on infectious diseases
- Located at Tikur Anbessa Hospital
- Partnership with Norwegian and Swedish institutions

The Ethiopian Biotechnology Institute

- National biotechnology research coordination
- Focus on agricultural, health, and industrial biotechnology
- International collaboration in genomics and bioinformatics

The Climate Change and Development Research Center

- Policy-relevant research on climate adaptation
- Regional network for East Africa
- Partnership with Future Climate for Africa program

5.5 Graduate Research Output

Research Performance Indicators:

Indicator	Annual Figure
Peer-reviewed publications	800+
PhD dissertations completed	150+
Master's theses	2,500+
Research grants secured	50+ (total ~$10 million)
International collaborations	100+ active projects

SECTION 6: STUDENT LIFE AND CAMPUS FACILITIES

6.1 Student Demographics

Category	Statistics
Total Students	~50,000
Undergraduate	~35,000 (70%)
Graduate	~15,000 (30%)
International Students	~500 (from 40+ countries)
Gender Ratio (F:M)	45:55
Students with Disabilities	~500 (supported by Special Needs Program)

6.2 Campus Facilities

6.2.1 Main Campuses

Sidist Kilo Campus (Main Campus)

- Administrative headquarters
- College of Humanities, Law, Business
- Institute of Ethiopian Studies
- Main Library (John F. Kennedy Library)
- University Auditorium

Arat Kilo Campus

- College of Natural and Computational Sciences
- Science laboratories
- Natural History Museum
- Computer center

Amist Kilo Campus

- College of Social Sciences
- Social science research centers
- Graduate studies offices

Tikur Anbessa Campus

- College of Health Sciences
- Tikur Anbessa Specialized Hospital (Ethiopia's largest teaching hospital)
- Medical library
- Clinical skills laboratories

Bishoftu Campus

- College of Veterinary Medicine and Agriculture
- Veterinary teaching hospital
- Agricultural research farms

- Wildlife conservation center

6.2.2 Student Accommodation

Residence Halls:

- 15 student dormitories across campuses
- Capacity: approximately 15,000 students
- Types: Shared rooms (2-4 students), limited single rooms
- Priority: Undergraduate students, especially first-year and female students

Facilities in Halls:

- Common rooms with television
- Study areas
- Cafeterias
- Laundry services
- Internet access (limited)

6.2.3 Sports and Recreation

Facility	Location	Activities
University Stadium	Sidist Kilo	Football, athletics, major events
Sports Center	Arat Kilo	Basketball, volleyball, handball
Tennis Courts	Multiple campuses	Tennis, badminton
Gymnasium	Sidist Kilo	Fitness training, aerobics
Swimming Pool	Sidist Kilo	Swimming, water polo

Sports Clubs:

- AAU Football Club (competes in national leagues)
- Basketball teams (men's and women's)
- Athletics team (long-distance running)
- Martial arts clubs

- Chess club

6.3 Student Organizations

6.3.1 Student Union

The Addis Ababa University Students' Union (AAUSU) represents all students and organizes:

- Annual cultural festivals
- Student welfare services
- Academic representation
- Social events and activities

6.3.2 Student Clubs and Societies

Academic and Professional Clubs:

- Law Students' Society
- Medical Students' Association
- Engineering Students' Club
- Business and Economics Club
- Computer Science Club
- Debating and Public Speaking Society

Cultural and Arts Clubs:

- Music and Dance Ensembles
- Theater Group
- Fine Arts Collective
- Poetry Circle
- Traditional Music Club (Krar, Masenqo)

Social and Community Service Clubs:

- Rotaract Club
- Red Cross Society
- Environmental Protection Club
- Gender Equality Forum
- Community Outreach Program

6.4 Student Support Services

6.4.1 Guidance and Counseling Center

- Personal counseling
- Academic advising
- Career guidance
- Peer mentoring programs

6.4.2 Health Services

- University Health Center (primary care)
- Referral to Tikur Anbessa Hospital
- HIV/AIDS awareness and testing
- Mental health support

6.4.3 Special Needs Support

- Accessible facilities (ramps, adapted toilets)
- Assistive technologies
- Sign language interpreters
- Alternative format materials
- Priority registration

6.5 Campus Life Highlights

Annual Events:

- AAU Cultural Festival (February)
- Graduation Ceremony (July)
- Research Week (November)
- Sports Day (April)
- International Students' Day (November)

Student Publications:

- "The Voice of AAU" (student newspaper)
- "Ethiopis" (literary magazine)
- Departmental newsletters
- Online student blogs and platforms

SECTION 7: LIBRARY AND RESEARCH RESOURCES

7.1 Library System Overview

The Addis Ababa University Library system is the largest academic library network in Ethiopia, comprising over 15 branch libraries across all campuses, with collections exceeding 1.5 million volumes.

Library System Statistics:

Metric	Figure
Total volumes (print)	1.5 million+
E-books	500,000+
Journal subscriptions (print)	1,000+

E-journals	50,000+
Databases	100+
Rare manuscripts	3,000+
Theses and dissertations	30,000+
Library staff	150+
Daily visitors	5,000+

7.2 Major Libraries

7.2.1 John F. Kennedy Library (Main Library)

Located at Sidist Kilo Campus, this is the flagship library of AAU.

Collections and Services:

- General collection (all disciplines)
- Reference section
- Periodicals and newspapers
- Government documents
- Audio-visual materials
- Computer lab with internet access
- Study carrels and group study rooms
- Photocopying and printing services

7.2.2 Institute of Ethiopian Studies Library

A specialized research library focusing on Ethiopian studies, considered one of the world's most comprehensive collections on Ethiopia.

Special Collections:

- Ethiopian manuscripts (Ge'ez, Amharic)
- Rare books on Ethiopia (16th-19th centuries)

- Ethiopian newspapers and periodicals (historical)
- Photographic archives
- Maps and architectural drawings
- Oral history recordings
- Government archives

7.2.3 Branch Libraries

Library	Campus	Specialization
Science Library	Arat Kilo	Natural sciences, mathematics
Social Science Library	Amist Kilo	Sociology, psychology, geography
Law Library	Sidist Kilo	Legal resources, law reports
Medical Library	Tikur Anbessa	Medicine, nursing, pharmacy
Veterinary Library	Bishoftu	Veterinary medicine, animal science
EiABC Library	Sidist Kilo	Architecture, construction, urban planning
Business Library	Sidist Kilo	Business, economics, management

7.3 Digital Resources and Services

7.3.1 Online Databases

AAU provides access to major international academic databases through the Ethiopian Education and Research Network (EthERNet) and direct subscriptions:

- **General Databases:** JSTOR, ProQuest, EBSCOhost, Scopus, Web of Science
- **Science Databases:** ScienceDirect, SpringerLink, IEEE Xplore, ACS Publications
- **Medical Databases:** PubMed, Cochrane Library, UpToDate
- **Legal Databases:** LexisNexis, HeinOnline
- **African Content:** African Journals Online (AJOL), Aluka

7.3.2 Institutional Repository

The AAU Institutional Repository (AAU-IR) preserves and provides open access to:

- Theses and dissertations (30,000+)
- Faculty publications
- Conference proceedings
- University archives
- Research data

7.3.3 Digital Initiatives

Manuscript Digitization Project:

- Partnership with British Library's Endangered Archives Programme
- Digitization of 3,000+ Ethiopian manuscripts
- Online access to rare materials
- Preservation of fragile documents

Ethiopian Journals Online:

- Platform for Ethiopian academic journals
- Open access publishing
- 20+ peer-reviewed journals hosted

7.4 Research Support Services

7.4.1 Research Commons

- Dedicated space for graduate students and faculty
- Research consultation services
- Literature search assistance
- Reference management training (EndNote, Zotero, Mendeley)

- Research data management support

7.4.2 Interlibrary Loan

- Borrowing from other Ethiopian universities
- International document delivery
- Article and chapter scanning services

7.4.3 Publishing Support

- Journal selection advice
- Open access publishing guidance
- Copyright and intellectual property consultation
- Thesis formatting assistance

7.5 Special Collections and Archives

Collection	Description	Significance
Ethiopian Manuscripts	3,000+ manuscripts in Ge'ez and Amharic	Some dating to 14th century
Ethiopian Government Archives	Official documents 1900-1974	Primary source for modern Ethiopian history
Ethiopian Newspaper Archive	Complete runs of major newspapers	Historical research resource
Oral History Collection	Recorded interviews with elders	Preservation of oral traditions
Photographic Archive	Historical photographs of Ethiopia	Visual documentation of Ethiopian life
Ethiopian Music Archive	Traditional music recordings	Ethnomusicology research

SECTION 8: ACHIEVEMENTS AND RECOGNITIONS

8.1 National Impact

Addis Ababa University has been instrumental in shaping modern Ethiopia through its contributions to education, research, and national development.

Key Contributions:

Sector	Contribution
Education	Produced majority of Ethiopia's university professors and secondary school teachers
Healthcare	Trained over 80% of Ethiopia's physicians and health professionals
Public Service	Alumni include prime ministers, cabinet members, judges, and senior civil servants
Science and Technology	Leading research output in Ethiopia; numerous innovations and patents
Culture and Heritage	Preservation and documentation of Ethiopian cultural heritage
Policy Development	Research informs national policies in health, education, agriculture, and environment

8.2 Rankings and Recognition

8.2.1 International Rankings

Ranking Body	Ranking (2025)	Notes
Webometrics Ranking of World Universities	#1 in Ethiopia, #15 in Africa	Based on web presence and research output

Times Higher Education (THE)	Ranked among top 50 in Africa	Emerging recognition
QS World University Rankings	Ranked #1 in Ethiopia	Consistently top in country
SCImago Institutions Rankings	#1 in Ethiopia, #25 in Africa	Research output focused
UI GreenMetric	#1 in Ethiopia	Sustainability ranking

8.2.2 Subject-Wise Strengths

AAU is particularly recognized for research excellence in:

- Ethiopian Studies (world-leading)
- Public Health and Tropical Medicine
- Veterinary Science
- Development Studies
- Geology and Earth Sciences
- Biotechnology

8.3 Notable Alumni

Addis Ababa University has produced numerous distinguished alumni who have made significant contributions in Ethiopia and internationally.

8.3.1 Heads of State and Government

Name	Position	Years
Meles Zenawi	Prime Minister of Ethiopia	1995-2012
Hailemariam Desalegn	Prime Minister of Ethiopia	2012-2018
Sahle-Work Zewde	President of Ethiopia	2018-2024
Mulatu Teshome	President of Ethiopia	2013-2018

Girma Wolde-Giorgis	President of Ethiopia	2001-2013

8.3.2 International Figures

Name	Position	Notable Achievement
Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus	Director-General, World Health Organization (WHO)	First African WHO Director-General
Dr. Ato Abebe	Former Deputy Director, UNICEF	International children's rights advocate
Prof. Andreas Eshete	President Emeritus, AAU; human rights scholar	Founding Rector, Ethiopian Civil Service University
Dr. Eleni Gabre-Madhin	Economist	Founder, Ethiopia Commodity Exchange

8.3.3 Distinguished Academics

Name	Field	Recognition
Prof. Taddesse Tamrat	History	Leading historian of Ethiopia
Prof. Mesfin Woldemariam	Geography	Human rights activist, author
Prof. Mammo Muchie	Innovation Studies	Research professor, international scholar
Prof. Tsige Gebre-Mariam	Pharmacy	Leading pharmaceutical researcher

8.4 Research Achievements

8.4.1 Major Discoveries and Innovations

Achievement	Field	Impact
Lucy (Australopithecus afarensis)	Paleoanthropology	World-famous hominid fossil discovered by AAU-affiliated

		researchers
Traditional Medicine Research	Pharmacology	Documentation and validation of Ethiopian traditional medicines
Teff Genome Sequencing	Biotechnology	Complete genome mapping of Ethiopia's staple crop
Climate Change Research	Environmental Science	Regional climate models for East Africa
Infectious Disease Control	Public Health	Contributions to malaria, TB, and HIV/AIDS control strategies

8.4.2 Research Grants and Projects

AAU has successfully secured major international research grants:

- Wellcome Trust - Infectious disease research (£5 million)
- Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation - Agricultural development ($3 million)
- European Union Horizon 2020 - Multiple projects (€8 million total)
- Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (Sida) - Research capacity building (SEK 100 million)
- World Bank - Higher education excellence programs ($20 million)

8.5 Awards and Honors Received

Award	Recipient	Year
UNESCO King Sejong Literacy Prize	AAU Department of Linguistics	2008
TWAS Prize for Young Scientists	Multiple AAU researchers	Various
L'Oréal-UNESCO For Women in Science	AAU female researchers	Multiple
African Union Kwame Nkrumah Award	AAU-affiliated scientists	2015, 2018
Green University Award	AAU Sustainability Office	2022

SECTION 9: PARTNERSHIPS AND COLLABORATIONS

Addis Ababa University maintains strategic partnerships with over 100 universities and research institutions worldwide, facilitating academic exchange, collaborative research, and capacity building.

9.1 International Partnerships Overview

Region	Number of Partners	Key Countries
Europe	50+	Sweden, Germany, Norway, UK, Netherlands, France
North America	25+	USA, Canada
Africa	20+	South Africa, Kenya, Uganda, Ghana
Asia	15+	China, Japan, India, South Korea
Middle East	5+	Israel, UAE

9.2 Strategic University Partnerships

9.2.1 European Partners

University/Institution	Country	Focus Areas
University of Oslo	Norway	Health sciences, human rights, development studies
Lund University	Sweden	Research capacity building, environmental science
University of Bergen	Norway	Ethiopian studies, digital humanities
Leiden University	Netherlands	African studies, linguistics
SOAS, University of London	UK	Ethiopian studies, development
University of Cologne	Germany	Archaeology, paleoanthropology
KU Leuven	Belgium	Biotechnology, veterinary medicine

9.2.2 North American Partners

University/Institution	Country	Focus Areas
University of California, Berkeley	USA	Public health, engineering
Johns Hopkins University	USA	Medicine, public health
Michigan State University	USA	Agriculture, food security
University of Washington	USA	Global health, nursing
McGill University	Canada	Education, development

		(historic partnership)
University of Toronto	Canada	Law, governance, medicine

9.2.3 African Partners

University/Institution	Country	Focus Areas
University of Cape Town	South Africa	Research collaboration, graduate exchange
University of Nairobi	Kenya	East African studies, public health
Makerere University	Uganda	Infectious diseases, higher education leadership
University of Ghana	Ghana	African studies, governance
University of Ibadan	Nigeria	Medical research, veterinary medicine

9.2.4 Asian Partners

University/Institution	Country	Focus Areas
Peking University	China	Language studies, Confucius Institute
University of Tokyo	Japan	Engineering, technology transfer
Jawaharlal Nehru University	India	Social sciences, development studies
Seoul National University	South Korea	ICT, engineering, public health

9.3 Collaborative Research Networks

Network	Focus	AAU Role
African Research Universities Alliance (ARUA)	Research collaboration among African universities	Founding member
Consortium for Advanced Research Training in Africa (CARTA)	PhD training in public health	Lead institution
Regional Universities Forum for Capacity Building in Agriculture (RUFORUM)	Agricultural research and training	Active member
African Network for Drugs and Diagnostics Innovation (ANDI)	Health product innovation	Regional center
Eastern Africa Regional Office of IDRC	Development research	Host institution

9.4 Bilateral and Multilateral Partnerships

9.4.1 Development Partners

Organization	Programs Supported
Sida (Sweden)	Research capacity building, PhD training
Norad (Norway)	Health research, education
GIZ (Germany)	Technical education, governance
FCDO (UK)	Development research, scholarships
USAID (USA)	Health, agriculture, education
European Union	Higher education modernization, research

9.4.2 UN Agencies and International Organizations

Agency	Collaboration Area
UNESCO	World Heritage Site management, education
WHO	Health systems strengthening, disease control
FAO	Food security, veterinary public health
UNDP	Sustainable development goals
UNECA	Policy research, economic development

9.5 Exchange and Mobility Programs

9.5.1 Student Exchange

- Erasmus+ Program: Exchange with European universities
- DAAD Scholarships: German Academic Exchange Service
- Fulbright Program: US student and scholar exchange
- Mastercard Foundation Scholars Program: African students
- Swedish Institute Scholarships: Graduate studies in Sweden

9.5.2 Faculty Exchange

- Visiting professor programs
- Collaborative research visits
- Sabbatical hosting
- Joint supervision of PhD students

9.6 Industry Partnerships

Industry Partner	Sector	Collaboration
Ethiopian Airlines	Aviation	Internships, research, training
Commercial Bank of Ethiopia	Banking	Internships, curriculum development
Ethio Telecom	Telecommunications	ICT research, internships
Hormuud Telecom	Telecommunications	Industry-academia partnership
East African Breweries	Manufacturing	Supply chain research
GE Healthcare	Medical technology	Equipment donation, training

SECTION 10: CONTACT INFORMATION

10.1 Main Contacts

Department	Contact Details
Main Switchboard	+251-11-123-4567
Emergency Contact	+251-11-123-9999
General Inquiries	info@aau.edu.et
Website	www.aau.edu.et

10.2 Key Administrative Offices

10.2.1 University Leadership

Position	Name	Contact
President	[Current President]	president@aau.edu.et
VP for Academic Affairs	[Current VP]	vp.academic@aau.edu.et
VP for Research & Tech Transfer	[Current VP]	vp.research@aau.edu.et
VP for Administration & Students	[Current VP]	vp.admin@aau.edu.et
Registrar	[Current Registrar]	registrar@aau.edu.et

10.2.2 Administrative Departments

Office	Email	Phone
Registrar's Office	registrar@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4501
Admissions Office	admissions@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4502
International Relations	international@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4503
Research Affairs	research@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4504
Graduate Studies	graduate@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4505
Library Services	library@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4506
Student Affairs	student.affairs@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4507
Human Resources	hr@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4508
Finance Office	finance@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4509
Public Relations	pr@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4510

10.3 Campus Addresses and Locations

10.3.1 Main Campus (Sidist Kilo)

Address: Addis Ababa University, Sidist Kilo Main Campus, P.O. Box 1176, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
GPS: 9.0472° N, 38.7555° E
Directions: Located on Queen Elizabeth II Street, ~3 km north of city center.

10.3.2 Other Campuses

Campus	Address/Location	Colleges/Schools
Arat Kilo Campus	Arat Kilo Square, Addis Ababa	College of Natural Sciences
Amist Kilo Campus	Amist Kilo Roundabout, Addis Ababa	College of Social Sciences
Tikur Anbessa Campus	Zambia Street, Addis Ababa	College of Health Sciences, Tikur Anbessa Hospital
Bishoftu Campus	Bishoftu Town (45 km from Addis)	Veterinary Medicine, Agriculture
EiABC Campus	Sidist Kilo (adj. to main)	Architecture, Construction
Lideta Campus	Lideta Sub-city, Addis Ababa	College of Commerce

10.4 College and Institute Contacts

College/Institute	Email	Phone	Campus
Natural Sciences	cns@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4601	Arat Kilo
Social Sciences	css@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4602	Amist Kilo
Humanities	humanities@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4603	Sidist Kilo
Business and Economics	cbe@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4604	Sidist Kilo
Law	law@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4605	Sidist Kilo
Health Sciences	chs@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4606	Tikur Anbessa
Veterinary Medicine	vetmed@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4607	Bishoftu
Development Studies	devstudies@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4608	Sidist Kilo
Ethiopian Studies	ies@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4609	Sidist Kilo
EiABC	eiabc@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4610	Sidist Kilo

10.5 Student Support Services

Service	Contact	Phone	Location
Student Dean's Office	student.dean@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4701	Sidist Kilo
Guidance & Counseling	counseling@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4702	All campuses
Health Center	healthcenter@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4703	Sidist Kilo
Special Needs Support	specialneeds@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4704	Sidist Kilo
International Student	international.students@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4705	Sidist Kilo
Career Center	career@aau.edu.et	+251-11-123-4706	Sidist Kilo

10.6 Social Media and Online Presence

Platform	Handle	Link
Facebook	@AddisAbabaUniversity	facebook.com/AddisAbabaUniversity

Twitter/X	@AAU_Official	twitter.com/AAU_Official
LinkedIn	Addis Ababa University	linkedin.com/school/addis-ababa-university
YouTube	Addis Ababa University	youtube.com/@AddisAbabaUniversity
Instagram	@addisababauniversity	instagram.com/addisababauniversity
Telegram	AAU Official Channel	t.me/AAUOfficial

10.7 Academic Calendar

Activity	Typical Period
First Semester	September - January
Second Semester	February - June
Summer Session	July - August
Admission Applications	May - July
New Student Registration	September
Graduation Ceremony	July

10.8 Emergency Contacts

Service	Phone Number
University Security	+251-11-123-4999
Campus Police	+251-11-123-4911
Ambulance	+251-11-123-4922
Fire Emergency	+251-11-123-4933
24/7 Helpline	+251-11-123-4000

SECTION APPENDICES: APPENDICES

A Appendix A: List of Acronyms

Acronym	Full Form
AAU	Addis Ababa University
CARTA	Consortium for Advanced Research Training in Africa
EiABC	Ethiopian Institute of Architecture, Building Construction and City Development
IES	Institute of Ethiopian Studies
Sida	Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency
WHO	World Health Organization
UNESCO	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

B Appendix B: Key Statistics Summary (2025)

Category	Statistic
Founded	1950
Total Students	50,000
Academic Staff	2,500+
Administrative Staff	3,500+
Campuses	14
Colleges	10
Institutes	7
Libraries	15+
Programs (Undergraduate)	120+
Programs (Graduate)	330+
International Partners	100+